

DMS.app User Manual

DMS is a document and photo management system that runs on your own computer. It organizes the real files on your hard drive into a folder tree you can browse and search, all through your web browser — nothing is uploaded to any cloud server. This manual assumes you have never used DMS before: it starts with "how do I install it" and walks through the exact clicks for every feature.

Document	Audience	Platforms	Chapters
User Manual — rev. 2026-09-12	First-time DMS users	macOS · Windows	01-16 + FAQ

01 Install & First Launch

DMS needs no account and no system-level install — download it and you have a program you can double-click straight away. From the very first step, every file you add lives only on the hard drive location you choose yourself.

1.1 Download

Use the button at the top of this page for your computer: "Download for Mac" or "Download for Windows". You'll get a .zip archive.

- 1 Once downloaded, find the .zip in your Downloads folder and double-click to unzip it.
- 2 Inside you'll find **DMS.app** (Mac) or **DMS.exe** (Windows). Drag it into Applications (Mac) or wherever you'll remember on your Desktop, so it's easy to find later.

1.2 First launch

- 1 Double-click **DMS.app** or **DMS.exe**.
- 2 A small status window titled "QC Document Management System (QCDMS)" appears first, showing status and a URL link. **Don't close this window** — it's DMS's background server; closing it quits the whole program.
- 3 After about a second, your default browser (Chrome recommended) opens automatically to the DMS web interface. If it doesn't, click the underlined URL in the status window.

Tip

That small status window has a **"Quit DMS"** button (bottom-right) to fully exit the program, and a **"Remote Upload"** button (bottom-left) used in Chapter 13, "Mobile & Remote Access" — you can ignore it for now.

1.3 Set your storage location

On first launch, the browser shows a "Set storage location" page asking you to pick one folder — every PDF, image, and index DMS ever saves will physically live inside it.

- 1 In the "Storage path" field, paste or type a folder path. If it doesn't exist yet, DMS creates it automatically. For example:
Mac: `/Users/yourname/Documents/DMS_Storage`
Windows: `C:\Users\yourname\Documents\DMS_Storage`
- 2 Click **"Save and continue"**.
- 3 The app initializes and takes you straight to the main screen.

Important

On Mac, do **not** pick a folder inside iCloud Drive (e.g. a Desktop or Documents folder with "Desktop & Documents sync" turned on) — iCloud can silently move infrequently-used files off your local disk, which can make DMS unable to read them. For free cloud backup, use a OneDrive- or Dropbox-synced folder instead (see Chapter 14).

Spend two minutes getting familiar with these areas — every later chapter refers back to them.

2.1 The top toolbar

- A 中文 / EN toggle — switches the whole interface's language instantly; your saved data is unaffected.
- The **Project** button — opens a dropdown with export/import backups, global settings, and password protection, covered in Chapters 14, 15, and 16.
- The current **storage path** button — shows the folder in use; click it to switch to a different folder (i.e. a different "project").
- If the current project has a project password set, a padlock–badged project name shows here too.

2.2 Four tabs

Below the toolbar are four tabs:

Tree	The default view. Folders on the left, documents in the selected folder on the right — Chapters 3–5 mostly happen here.
Search	Keyword search, or switch to "Ask AI" to question the whole library — see Chapters 6 and 8.
Data book	Merge multiple documents into one cover–paged PDF — see Chapter 11.
Faces	Browse tagged photos by person — see Chapter 10.

2.3 Layout of the Tree tab

- **Left:** the folder tree, expandable/collapsible, right–click any folder for its menu. Just above it sits a row of quick buttons: New folder, Upload document, Rename, Delete, Text tree, Plot.
- **Right:** the list of documents in the currently selected folder.

The folder tree is DMS's backbone. It's worth spending a few minutes sketching out the rough structure that matches how you actually think about your files (by equipment, by client, by family member) before adding documents.

3.1 Create a folder

- 1 In the left tree, click to select a "parent" folder (the new folder will be created inside it).
 - 2 Right-click that folder and choose **"New subfolder"**, or click the **"New folder"** button in the toolbar above the tree.
 - 3 Type a name and press Enter.
-

3.2 Rename & delete

- 1 **Rename:** right-click a folder → "Rename", or double-click its name, edit, and press Enter. The real folder on disk is renamed to match.
- 2 **Delete:** right-click a folder → "Delete folder" and confirm — the folder and everything under it (subfolders and documents) is removed.

Be careful

Deleting a folder deletes the real files on disk too, and doesn't go through a recycle bin — it can't be undone directly. For anything important, export a backup first (Chapter 14) before deleting.

3.3 Drag to move, reorder, or merge

- 1 Press and hold the left mouse button on a folder to drag it.
- 2 Drop it directly **on top of** another folder (it highlights) → moves it **inside** that folder, becoming a subfolder of it.
- 3 Drop it on the top or bottom edge of another folder → moves it to become that folder's **previous/next sibling** (reorders only, doesn't change parents).

Automatic merging

If the target folder already has a subfolder with the exact same name, DMS automatically merges the two — every document and subfolder from the source is folded into the target, so you never end up with duplicate same-named folders.

3.4 Folder serial number (SN)

Each folder can carry a serial number (e.g. A-001) to match your existing asset or part numbering. Subfolders and their documents default to "inheriting" their parent's SN unless they set their own.

- 1 In the folder details panel on the right, find the "Serial number (SN)" field.
- 2 Type the number and save. It appears on document cards so you can identify what they belong to at a glance.

3.5 Bulk-build a whole tree from a list

If you already have a written-out folder structure (e.g. a project's filing categories), you don't have to create each folder by hand — paste an indented outline and import it all at once.

- 1 Click "Project" → "Create folder tree from a hierarchy file" in the top toolbar.
- 2 Paste your hierarchy definition into the dialog: one folder name per line, with indentation (e.g. 2 spaces per level) showing nesting. The same part name is allowed to repeat legitimately under different parents (like a bill-of-materials).
- 3 Click "Preview" to check the parsed result, then "Import" once it looks right.

Supported image formats include PDF, JPG, PNG, HEIC, TIFF, GIF, WEBP, and BMP, plus text files like TXT. In principle any file type can be uploaded and stored, though not every format can be previewed directly in the browser. Maximum size per file is 4GB.

4.1 Drag and drop (the fastest way)

- 1 Click to select the target folder in the left tree.
 - 2 Drag files straight from the Desktop or a Finder/Explorer window onto the document area on the right.
 - 3 Release — the file uploads automatically and appears in the document list.
-

4.2 Upload via the button

- 1 With a folder selected, click **"Upload document"** in the toolbar above the tree, or right-click the folder → "Upload document".
 - 2 In the file picker, select files (hold Cmd/Ctrl to multi-select) and click "Open".
-

4.3 Paste a screenshot straight from the clipboard

No need to save a screenshot to the Desktop first — take the screenshot, then press **Cmd+V** (Mac) or **Ctrl+V** (Windows) anywhere on the DMS page to drop it straight into the current folder.

4.4 Upload while keeping an existing folder structure

If you already have a whole set of material organized into folders on your computer (e.g. a project's full directory), you can choose to recreate that exact subfolder layout inside DMS instead of letting it auto-sort everything by date.

4.5 Descriptions, voice input & AI polish

Every document and photo can carry a free-text "description" — it's saved into the search index and fully searchable.

- **Voice input:** click the voice-input button next to the description box and just speak — the transcribed text is appended automatically (works best in Chrome/Edge), and you can freely mix typing and dictation.
- **AI organize & polish** (needs AI configured, Chapter 8): dictated or quickly-typed text often comes out rough — click **"Organize & polish"** and pick one of "Organize", "Polish wording", or "Make concise". The AI's result is shown for you to review first; it only replaces your original text once you accept it.
- **Check typos:** click **"Check typos"** to have AI specifically flag typos, punctuation issues, and misused idioms in the description, listed one by one for you to fix.
- **Saving:** click **"Save and make searchable"** to store the text in the index only; to also save this description as its own standalone `.txt` document you can open, download, or share like any other file, click **"Save as new document"** (once saved, this becomes "Update description file" so you can keep revising the same one).

4.6 Photos and videos auto-filed by year and month

Once a folder is set as the "photo root" (Chapter 10), uploaded photos automatically read their capture date and get filed into "2026" → "08"-style year/month subfolders under it. If a photo carries GPS data, the shooting location is picked up too. HEIC photos from an iPhone preview correctly with no manual conversion.

Videos are now filed the same way: MP4/MOV-family files use the recording timestamp embedded in the video itself, while other video formats fall back to the file's own modified date.

4.7 Bulk import from a ZIP

If you have a large batch of documents whose filenames already start with the name or number of their target folder (e.g. `A-001_spec-sheet.pdf` for the folder numbered A-001), you can zip them up and let DMS sort them all at once.

- 1 Click **"Project"** → **"Bulk import documents from ZIP"**.
 - 2 Drop in the ZIP file — DMS shows which files match which folder, and which couldn't be matched.
 - 3 Confirm to finish the import.
-

4.8 Duplicate files

On upload, DMS automatically checks for files with identical content already in the library. If it finds a match, it asks whether to skip, link the existing file into this folder instead (no extra disk space used), or upload it anyway as a new file.

05

Viewing, Downloading & Organizing Documents

5.1 Previewing a document

- 1 Click any document in the list to preview it right on the page: PDFs support page navigation and zoom, plus a "find in document" search that tolerates small OCR typos and jumps straight to the highlighted match; images show at full size; text files display their content directly.
- 2 To open it in another app installed on your computer instead (e.g. Word for a .docx), click "Open in native app" and DMS hands it to your system's default program.

5.2 Rename & download

- Click "Rename" on a document's card to change both the file on disk and its display name at once.
- Select one or more documents and click "Download" to copy them to a folder of your choice (the system Downloads folder by default), with the option to open that folder right away.

5.3 Linking one document into several folders

The same document can appear in multiple folders without using extra disk space — this is called "linking".

- 1 Open the target folder and click "Link existing document".
- 2 Search or browse for the document in the dialog that opens; you can also **drag** a result straight onto a folder on the left to link it in one motion, with no per-item confirm click needed.
- 3 The document now appears in the current folder while still remaining in its original one; its card shows "Linked to N node(s)".

About deleting a link

Removing a link only detaches that one folder's reference to the document — it doesn't delete the actual file. Only once every reference is removed does the file actually move off disk (into the recycle area below).

5.4 Combine into one PDF

Merge several selected scans or files into a single PDF, filed back into a folder you choose; the originals stay untouched in storage. Quick merges skip the formal cover page — per-document bookmarks alone handle navigation — and any landscape page is automatically rotated to portrait so the whole file stays consistently oriented.

5.5 Opening a document keeps it highlighted

Any document you've opened (in the built-in preview or a native app) stays highlighted in its folder's list, so you can spot it again at a glance later.

5.6 Deleting a document

Click the delete button on a document's card and confirm. If the document is linked into other folders, only the current folder's reference is removed; if this was its last reference, the file is moved into the "Not Show in Tree" recycle folder on disk (not immediately erased — you can find or permanently clear it there manually).

5.7 View mode, sorting & batch rename

- **List / icon view:** toggle between "List view" (one detailed row per document) and "Icon view" (a thumbnail grid, like Windows Explorer) at the top right of the document area; in icon view, a further "Small"/"Large" toggle controls thumbnail size — handy for browsing photos quickly, and your choice is remembered.
- **Sorting:** the "Sort by" dropdown above the document list orders the current folder's documents by name (A–Z), document date (metadata), due date (metadata), or date modified.
- **Previous / next:** with a document open in the preview window, click the arrows on either side of it, or just press the left/right arrow keys, to step through the current folder's documents without closing and reopening the preview each time.
- **Batch rename:** click **"Batch rename"** in the toolbar to generate a new filename for every document in the current folder — in the form "date + first 10 characters of location + original name" (e.g. 20260815SanFrancisco-contract.pdf), using each document's own date and location metadata. Review the preview list, confirm, and every file is renamed at once — including the actual file on disk.

5.8 Due dates & "Schedule" color warnings

Set a due date on any individual document — a permit's expiry, a warranty deadline, a renewal date — and DMS warns you with color as it approaches, so you don't have to track the date yourself.

- 1 Click **"Due date"** on a document's card, pick a date, and save (leave it blank and save to clear an existing due date).
- 2 Click **"Schedule"** in the top toolbar to turn on color warnings: every document with a due date, and every folder containing one, is automatically color-coded by urgency — **red for due within 1 day or overdue, yellow for within 1 week, blue for within 2 weeks** — with a matching color legend shown right in the toolbar.
- 3 Turning on Schedule mode also opens a **"Documents due soon"** list, showing every document due within 2 weeks ranked by urgency, along with its folder path and exact due date — click any row to open that document directly. It's a standalone popup you can close and reopen anytime by clicking "Schedule" again.

6.1 Extracting text (OCR)

For a scan or an image with no selectable text layer, DMS can recognize the text inside it. Once recognized, that text becomes searchable and can also auto-fill key parameters.

- 1 Open a document's preview.
- 2 Click **"Extract text (OCR)"**. If the document already has a selectable text layer, DMS reads it directly; for a pure image or scan, it runs the OCR engine.
- 3 Once recognized, the text appears and can be hand-corrected before saving.

Scan has a bad text layer?

If a PDF already has a text layer but it's wrong (common with certain scanning software), click **"Force OCR"** to ignore the existing layer and re-recognize the page image from scratch.

6.2 Keyword search

- 1 Switch to the top "Search" tab (or use the search box in the top-right of the Tree view).
- 2 Type a number, filename, description, or metadata keyword — results filter live as you type.

Search covers filenames, the full text from OCR, and every metadata field you've added to a document (Chapter 7). DMS also flags likely-unreliable garbled OCR output so it doesn't pollute your search results.

Pulling specific parameters out of a document — a "blood glucose level" from a physical exam report, a "yield strength" from a material test report, a "class rank" from a report card — and using them for later analysis and reporting is one of DMS's core features. "Key parameters" are how it's done: custom information fields you attach to a document. Once filled in, this data is searchable, and can also become the data points behind Chapter 9's

trend charts. If none of this is familiar yet, think of it simply as tagging each document with your own custom labels and values.

For most documents, keyword-match extraction (Section 7.4) — or just typing values in by hand — already gets very high accuracy. AI-assisted extraction (Section 8.2) is a supplement, only really needed for documents with a complicated layout or values scattered across charts and tables, to further improve how well extraction handles those trickier cases.

7.1 Managing the global field list

DMS ships with a few common field names already set up; you can add or remove your own. Once set, any field you start typing on a document will suggest these names, keeping naming consistent.

- 1 Click **"Project"** → **"Global key parameters"**.
 - 2 Click **"Add"** to type a new field name; click the **X** next to a field to remove it; drag to reorder.
 - 3 Click **"Save"** — the global list takes effect immediately.
-

7.2 Adding a value to one document

- 1 Open a document and expand its metadata / key-parameters area.
- 2 Click **"Add field"** and pick an existing name from the dropdown (or type a new one that belongs only to this document, without joining the global list).
- 3 Type the value next to it and save — it writes immediately.

7.3 Design value vs. actual value

Each parameter can hold both a "design" and an "actual" reading at once, each with its own value, unit, and description — a complete, ready-to-use data structure, useful whenever you need to check a design requirement against a real-world measurement (e.g. equipment acceptance testing).

That structure is good for more than just checking one reading against another: the same data applies directly to compliance checks, comparing equipment purchase options, and structural safety analysis. And as it accumulates over time, you're also building up a clean, structured, high-quality dataset ready for equipment-upgrade decisions, trend analysis, or handing off to a manufacturer's or third-party AI for further analysis down the road.

7.4 Extracting automatically from a document's text

Once a document has been through Chapter 6's text recognition, DMS can search that text for your field names and pull out the numbers that follow, instead of you typing each one by hand.

- 1 In the text-recognition panel, click **"Extract key parameters"**.
 - 2 Check the field names you want extracted.
 - 3 Click **"Start extraction"** — DMS searches the full text for each field's keyword and the value that follows it.
 - 4 Review the results — each match is automatically split into value, unit, and description rather than one raw blob of text; a field that appears more than once in the document is captured as separate, numbered results ("Pressure_01", "Pressure_02", ...) so nothing is missed.
 - 5 Click "Apply to document" once it looks right.
-

Tip for tables

Check "Same-line only" so DMS only matches content on the same line as the field name — ideal for tabular documents; leave it unchecked to search the whole text instead.

7.5 The preview flyout while checking values

While entering or double-checking a parameter by hand, you can pop open a draggable, freely-resizable preview of the source document, so you can look at the original text while you type — no more tabbing back and forth.

7.6 Exporting all metadata as a spreadsheet

Click "Project" → "Export Metadata (CSV)" to export every document's full set of key parameters as a spreadsheet, ready to open directly in Excel for review or further analysis.

08

AI Assistance (Optional)

Everything in this chapter is **optional** — leaving it unconfigured doesn't affect anything else in the app. It requires an API key of your own from an AI service (free or low-cost) and an internet connection. DMS now supports two AI providers: Google's **Gemini** and **DeepSeek** (faster and steadier for users in mainland China). Set up one or both, and switch between them anytime.

8.1 Getting and configuring a key

- 1 Click "Project" → "AI-assisted extraction settings" to open the "AI provider settings" dialog.
- 2 **Gemini:** click "Don't have an API Key? Get one for free at Google AI Studio" — aistudio.google.com/apikey. Sign in with a Google account, create a key, then copy and paste it into DMS.
- 3 **DeepSeek:** click "Don't have an API Key? Get one at the DeepSeek platform" and repeat the same steps.
- 4 Once saved, the key is encrypted at rest — never stored as plain text.

On cost

Gemini's free tier processes up to 3 pages of a document at a time — plenty for most medical reports or product test reports. For documents running dozens or even hundreds of pages, a Gemini paid subscription (about \$10/month) lifts that limit; the paid tier also comes with Google's commitment not to use your uploaded files to train its models, which matters for anything privacy- or business-sensitive.

8.2 AI-assisted key parameter extraction

For documents with a complicated layout that plain text matching can't handle (values scattered across charts or complex tables), let AI read the actual page image instead of just matching text. In the extraction panel from Section 7.4, check "Use AI" before starting extraction.

8.3 Asking AI across the whole project

- 1 Switch to the top "Search" tab and click **"Ask AI"**.
 - 2 Type a plain-language question, e.g. "What is the equipment's working pressure?"
 - 3 Pick Gemini or DeepSeek and ask — AI searches across every document and cites exactly which one each answer came from, so you can verify the source.
-

You can also scope the question to just one folder (check "This node and its subfolders only") instead of the entire project.

8.4 Q&A history saved automatically

Every question you ask and every answer AI gives is automatically appended to a running PDF log tied to that document — always available to reopen from the document list, and fully searchable, with nothing extra to organize yourself.

8.5 Package as a PDF for any AI platform (ChatGPT, Gemini, etc.)

The built-in "Ask AI" (Section 8.3) is great for quick lookups, but if you want to turn a set of photos and a story into a video, an article, or some other creative output DMS doesn't produce itself, use "Build PDF" instead: it bundles your photos, your request to the AI, and a story about those photos into one PDF, for you to hand to ChatGPT, Gemini, or whichever AI platform you prefer.

- 1 In the "Ask AI about this folder" dialog (same entry point as Section 8.3), check the photos you want to use.
- 2 Write in the question box — it's a single free-text field, so use it however you like: a specific instruction to the AI (e.g. "make a video from these photos, with soft background music"), a story or description of the photos, or both together.
- 3 Besides typing, you can also click the voice-input button and dictate your request or story directly; once you're done, click **"Organize & polish"** to clean up what you said into something more readable (works exactly like the description box in Section 4.5).
- 4 Click **"Build PDF (for ChatGPT etc.)"**. DMS compresses the selected photos into a small but sharp PDF and bundles your written request and story in alongside them, then downloads the result.
- 5 Upload that PDF to ChatGPT, Gemini, or any other AI platform that accepts file uploads and can read images, and make your request there as usual. Since the photos are already a lightweight PDF, uploading and processing stays smooth even with a large batch selected.

How this differs from Section 8.3

"Ask AI now" in 8.3 calls Gemini/DeepSeek directly, inside DMS, for a text answer. "Build PDF" here instead hands your material to an external AI platform of your choice — better suited to creative tasks DMS itself doesn't generate, like video or long-form writing.

09 Trend Charts

If a key parameter (like "Cholesterol", "Account Balance", or "Working Pressure") repeats across several documents in the same folder, DMS can plot it against date automatically — no need to export to Excel and chart it by hand.

9.1 Generating a chart

- 1 Select the folder you want to analyze in the left tree.
- 2 Click the **"Plot"** button in the toolbar above the tree.
- 3 Pick the key–parameter field to plot, and whether to include all subfolders.
- 4 DMS plots that parameter's value from every document against date, as a line chart. Dates come first from each document's own detected or entered date; if a document has none, DMS falls back to the "YYYY–MM" folder it's filed under.

Click any plotted point, or a row in the table below it, to jump straight to the source document — a quick way to double–check where a number actually came from.

9.2 Adjusting the chart window

- Drag the chart window's header to move it, or drag an edge/corner to resize it.
 - Click "Pop out" to open the chart in its own separate browser window — handy for dragging onto a second monitor.
 - Both the time axis and value axis can be toggled between Auto and Custom range; switching to Custom starts from the current auto–fit range and updates live as you edit it.
-

9.3 Annualized return (for tracking balances and investments)

Pick any point on the chart as a "baseline" to see every other point's annualized return relative to it; you can also view the chained, point–to–point annualized return between neighboring points. Especially useful when tracking an account balance or investment performance over time.

9.4 Excel snapshot history (for hand–tracked totals)

Some numbers — like a total bank balance — don't come from any single document; they're a running total you check and record yourself from time to time. That's what "snapshots" are for:

- 1 Click **"Save snapshot"** in the chart window to append today's date and value to a per–folder, per–parameter Excel history file.
- 2 Switch to the "Total vs. time" view to read that history straight back into a chart — no extraction from any single document needed.

9.5 AI trend commentary (optional)

If AI is already configured (Chapter 8), click to enable an AI read on the trend's direction, its approximate rate of change, and any outliers worth a second look.

10

Photos & Face Recognition

10.1 Setting a photo root folder

First designate one folder as your photo library's root — every automatically-organized photo from then on lands somewhere under it.

- 1 Right-click the folder you want as the root (e.g. create a new folder called "Photos").
- 2 Choose **"Set as photo root folder"**.
- 3 Its icon changes to a camera icon, confirming it's set. To undo this, right-click and choose "Unset photo root folder".

Note

Only one photo root is allowed per project.

10.2 Uploading photos

Uploading a photo into the photo root (or one of its subfolders) makes DMS automatically read its capture date (EXIF data) and create the matching "year/month" subfolders under the root to file it into. If the photo carries GPS data, the shooting location is picked up too, shown as a "Location" metadata field with a one-click link to view it on a map.

10.3 Tagging a face

- 1 Select one or more photos.
- 2 Click "Tag faces", draw a box around a person in the photo, and type their name (the first time you tag someone, a new "person" entry is created; reuse the same name afterward to group photos under that same person).

10.4 Browsing photos by person

- 1 Switch to the top **"Faces"** tab.
 - 2 Click any tagged person to see every photo of them across the whole library.
 - 3 Click "Auto-scan for matches" to search a folder or the entire library for more photos of that person (or everyone), with an adjustable match-confidence threshold.
-

To remove someone, delete the person and every one of their tags in a single action — the photos themselves are untouched. The first time you use face recognition, DMS guides you through installing the underlying engine, with live progress shown.

10.5 Finding near–duplicate photos

Burst shots, repeated saves, or re–exports often leave several nearly–identical copies of the same photo scattered through a batch. DMS can automatically find these "near–duplicates" and recommend which one to keep.

- 1 Open a folder containing photos and click **"Find near–duplicates"** next to the **"Select"** button in the toolbar to enter photo–selection mode.
- 2 Check the photos you want to compare (only image files can be selected), and set the **similarity threshold** on the right (defaults to 75% — higher means a stricter match).
- 3 Click **"Check selected"**. DMS compares every pair of the checked photos and groups the ones that meet the threshold together, showing each group's lowest pairwise similarity.
- 4 Within each group, DMS marks the photo with the highest resolution and largest file size (usually the least–compressed, best–quality copy) with a ★ **badge** as the suggested keeper — the final call is still yours.
- 5 When you're happy with the groups, click **"Mark for review"**. DMS links (not moves) each group's photos into a new "Group N" subfolder under a "Suspected duplicates" folder at the root, leaving the originals exactly where they were, so you can review, compare, and delete at your own pace.

Thumbnail size

Both the results dialog and the normal grid view offer a "Small"/"Large" thumbnail toggle for closer comparison — your choice is remembered for next time (see Section 5.7).

Deleting inside "Suspected duplicates" is what actually cleans up

Photos in this review folder are only linked there — the originals still live in their own folders, and by the general rule in Section 5.6, deleting elsewhere normally just removes that one reference. But deleting a photo directly from inside "Suspected duplicates / Group N" removes it from **every** location it's linked to, including the original folder, and moves it into the "Not Show in Tree" recycle folder — which is what actually frees up space and cleans up the duplicate.

The "Data book" feature merges any set of documents you select from the folder tree into one formal PDF, complete with a cover page, table of contents, and per-section bookmarks — ideal as a handoff package or for archival printing.

- 1 Switch to the top **"Data book"** tab.
 - 2 Check the documents to merge in the document picker — you can select across multiple folders.
 - 3 Fill in a title and subtitle for the databook (optionally insert your own cover page ahead of the auto-generated one).
 - 4 Click **"Generate and download"** — DMS arranges everything into a section structure following folder order and serial numbers, then merges it into one PDF.
- Image-only folders convert automatically into print-ready PDF pages.
 - A landscape source page rotates automatically to portrait, so the whole book stays consistently oriented.
 - With many photos involved, images are intelligently re-compressed before embedding — near-invisible on the page, but the whole file can shrink to roughly one-hundredth of its original size.

Tip

Your selection and title are remembered automatically after you generate once, so reopening the "Data book" tab next time picks up right where you left off.

12 Sharing Documents

12.1 Sending by email

Set up an SMTP mail account once first (works the same on Mac and Windows):

- 1 Click **"Project"** → **"Email sending settings"**.
- 2 Click the quick-select button for your provider (Gmail / Yahoo / Outlook / iCloud / QQ Mail / 163) to auto-fill the server address and port.
- 3 Fill in your username (your email address) and password. **Gmail users must use an "App Password"**, not their normal account password — generate one separately in Google Account settings.
- 4 Click **"Send test email"** to verify — a test message should arrive in your inbox. Once confirmed, click **"Save settings"**.

Once set up, to send a document:

- 1 Click the email icon on a document's card.
- 2 Fill in the recipient's address (DMS remembers the last one you used), a subject (defaults to the document's name), and an optional message body.
- 3 Click **"Send email"** — it goes out directly over SMTP and typically arrives within moments.

Without SMTP configured

On Mac, DMS falls back to opening a draft in the Messages or Mail app for you; on Windows, SMTP must be configured first before you can send an email at all.

12.2 Send to phone

Click the phone icon on a document's card, enter the recipient's phone number, and click send. DMS generates a download link valid for **one hour** and sends it via the Mac Messages app (iMessage/SMS) or the Windows "Phone Link" app — the recipient needs no DMS-related app at all, just tap the link to download.

This chapter covers the reverse direction — sending photos or files from your phone into DMS, or browsing your computer's whole folder tree straight from your phone. Both are driven from **the small status window that appears at launch** (the "QCDMS" window from Section 1.2), not from the browser page itself.

13.1 Uploading photos or files from your phone into a folder

- 1 On your computer, find that small status window (check your taskbar/Dock if it's minimized) and click **"Remote Upload"**.
- 2 In the dialog, optionally enter a phone number (with country code, e.g. +16505551234), and pick which folder incoming files should land in from the dropdown.
- 3 Click **"Generate Link"** — DMS starts a secure public tunnel and produces a QR code and URL (this usually takes a few seconds to around ten).
- 4 Scan the QR code with your phone, or click "Send via iMessage / SMS / WeChat" to text the link directly — or "Copy URL" to send it manually.
- 5 Opening the link on the phone lets you take a photo or pick one from the camera roll and upload it straight away — it lands in the folder you chose in step 2.

Link expiry

This remote upload link is valid for **7 days**. After it expires, click "Generate Link" again to make a new one.

13.2 Browsing your computer's files from your phone

Opening the same link from Section 13.1 on your phone shows a "Browse" option on the page — tap it to browse the whole folder tree and open documents just as you would on the computer, not just upload new ones.

13.3 Local access on the same Wi-Fi

If your phone and computer share the same Wi-Fi network, you can skip the public tunnel entirely and open your computer's local network address in the phone's browser (something like `http://192.168.x.x:port/mobile`) to reach the same upload page. If you're not sure of your computer's local address, the "Remote Upload" flow from 13.1 is the simplest option since it works on any network.

14

Backup, Export & Import

Everything in DMS is ordinary files — nothing is locked into a proprietary format. Click the **"Project"** button at the top to see every backup/export option.

14.1 Three ways to export

Export index backup (.dms)	Saves just the folder tree structure and metadata — no actual files. Filenames start with <code>METADATA-</code> ; small and fast, good for preserving structure quickly.
Export full backup (with files)	Bundles the folder tree, metadata, and every actual document and photo together. Filenames start with <code>COMP-</code> — the most complete backup possible.
Export selected folders (with files)	Check specific folders first, and export only their tree and files. Filenames start with <code>PART-</code> — good for sharing or backing up just part of the library.

There's also "**Export Metadata (CSV)**" — exports every document's metadata as a spreadsheet for review or bookkeeping in Excel.

Only the last 10 are kept

Exported .dms backup files are saved inside the storage folder. The project folder keeps at most 10 .dms backups; older ones are automatically moved into the "Not Shown in The Tree" folder, so they never pile up indefinitely.

With a project password set

If the current project has a project password (Section 15.2), every one of the above exports is automatically encrypted with it — there's no separate export password to set.

14.2 Importing a .dms backup

- 1 Click "**Project**" → "**Import project (.dms)**", or drag a .dms file straight onto the upload area.
- 2 Choose a destination folder to extract it into.
- 3 Confirm — DMS extracts and imports, then automatically switches to the newly-imported project.

Import only restores the folder tree structure; it never deletes any existing files already on disk.

14.3 Starting a brand-new blank project

Click "Project" → "Create new blank project" and enter a new, empty folder path. The project you're currently using is unaffected, and you can switch back anytime using the storage path button at the top.

14.4 Free cloud backup

Point the storage path at a OneDrive or Dropbox folder that's already syncing, and every bit of DMS's data backs up to the cloud automatically along with that folder — no extra steps. A step-by-step OneDrive setup guide is available in-app (under "Downloads" in the Project menu).

One more reminder

On Mac, don't put the storage path inside iCloud Drive (see Section 1.3).

15

Security & Passwords

DMS offers two completely independent layers of password protection — use just one, or both.

15.1 App login password (protects DMS on this whole machine)

An optional login password protecting the entire DMS application on this machine, regardless of which project is currently open — good for a shared computer, or whenever you want DMS unreachable by anyone without the password.

- 1 Click **"Project"** → **"Set app login password"**.
- 2 Type a new password (twice to confirm) and save — it takes effect immediately. From then on, opening DMS in a browser requires this password first.
- 3 To change or remove it, return to the same menu item (now shown as "Change or remove app login password"), verify your current password, and proceed — leave the new password blank to remove it entirely.
- 4 Once a password is set, a "Log out" option appears in the menu — clicking it ends the current browser session, requiring the password again next time.

How it's stored

The password is stored encrypted (SHA256 with a random salt, 100,000 iterations) in a local config file — never in plain text.

15.2 Project password (protects just one specific project)

A completely separate, second password that belongs to one specific project — it's stored inside that project's own folder, so it travels along whenever the folder is copied, synced, or handed off. It's required to open that project directly, or to import its exported .dms file anywhere else.

- 1 Click **"Project"** → **"Set project password"**.
- 2 Optionally give the project a friendly name (shown on its lock screen and in the file picker), set a password, and save.
- 3 Once set, a padlock-badged project name appears in the toolbar; a "Lock this project" option appears in the menu — clicking it requires the project password again to keep viewing (without affecting the app login above).

15.3 Storing website logins per folder

Save one or more sets of related website address, username, and password against a specific folder — click "Add another login" to keep adding more — decrypted only when you click "reveal". Any folder can hold any number of these logins, with a "copy username" quick-action button included.

A common use: keep an online account's login right alongside the files it relates to, so the record and the access point live in one place. For example, store your hospital or doctor's patient-portal login in the same folder as your "Physical Exam Reports" — next time you need to check a result or book an appointment, you're not hunting for the password separately. The same pattern works well for an equipment manufacturer's admin portal, an insurance company's website, or a bank or investment account.

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Other Settings

- **Download the user manual / setup guides:** the "Downloads" section at the bottom of the "Project" menu offers a .docx copy of this manual, OneDrive setup guides (Chinese/English), and a Windows face-recognition install guide.
- **Switch storage location:** click the storage path button in the top toolbar anytime to switch to another DMS project folder already on your computer.
- **Language switch:** the whole interface can be toggled between Chinese and English anytime from the top of the screen, with no effect on your saved data.
- **Multiple projects at once:** run several DMS project windows/instances side by side and switch between them freely, with no need to close one before opening another.
- **No document count limit:** a project can hold an unlimited number of documents.

Frequently Asked Questions

I forgot the app login password — what do I do?

You can reset it by editing the local config file directly. It's located at
~/.pms_dms_config.json on Mac, or C:\Users\yourname\.pms_dms_config.json on

Windows. Open it in a plain text editor and set both the `password_hash` and `password_salt` fields to an empty string "", save, and restart DMS — password protection is removed. (This is the app login password, distinct from Section 15.2's "project password", which lives inside the project's own folder — the same edit-and-clear approach works on its config file there.)

I accidentally deleted a folder or document — can I get it back?

Deleting a document only removes one reference as long as it's linked elsewhere — the file itself stays. Only once the last reference is deleted does the file move into the "Not Show in Tree" folder on disk, where you can find it manually. Deleting an entire folder, however, is not reversible — export a backup (Chapter 14) before doing anything important. If your storage path is inside a cloud-synced folder (like OneDrive), its version history may also help recover a deleted file.

Why does sending email show an "SMTP error"?

Common causes: Gmail without an "App Password" (using the regular account password instead); a provider's SMTP access isn't turned on (QQ Mail and 163 both require enabling it manually in their web interface first); or a company firewall blocking ports 587/465 — contact your network admin in that case.

Can documents be shared across multiple computers?

Yes. Point the storage path at a shared network drive, or a cloud-synced folder (OneDrive, Dropbox — avoid iCloud Drive on Mac, see Section 1.3), and every computer's DMS pointed at that same path shares the data. Just avoid editing the same document from two computers at the same time to prevent conflicts — dividing work by folder is the safest approach.

Windows says "Windows protected your PC" (SmartScreen) when I double-click DMS.exe — what now?

This happens because DMS.exe is a newly-built executable that hasn't been paid-certified with a digital signature from Microsoft — Windows blocks unrecognized new programs by default to protect users; it doesn't mean anything is wrong with it. Two ways around it:

Option 1 (recommended, simplest): on the warning screen, click the "More info" link — a "Run anyway" button appears at the bottom; click it to launch normally.

Option 2: if that window is already closed or unresponsive, right-click DMS.exe → "Properties" → check the "Unblock" checkbox near the bottom of the "General" tab → click "Apply" → "OK". This permanently clears the warning for that file going forward.

What file formats are supported?

PDF, JPG, JPEG, PNG, HEIC, TIFF, GIF, WEBP, and BMP for images, plus text formats like TXT and CSV. In principle any file type can be uploaded and stored, but in-browser preview is limited to the formats listed above — anything else can still be downloaded and opened with the matching application.

What's the difference between DMS.app and DMS.exe — are they just the Mac and Windows versions?

Exactly — they're functionally identical, just packaged executables for Mac and Windows respectively. Double-click to run; no separate Python install or dependencies needed.